

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with direct experience supporting fee earners in a busy international law firm and managing client matters from instruction to completion. At BCLP, provided day-to-day legal PA-style support across international arbitration and real estate disputes: maintaining case files in iManage, tracking deadlines, coordinating documents and liaising with clients. At Citizens Advice, manages a caseload independently, drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules and communicates with clients on sensitive matters. Strong organisational skills, confident written communication and experience handling confidential information across competing deadlines.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Maintained structured electronic case files in iManage and monitored procedural deadlines across a complex investment arbitration
- Coordinated document schedules and tracked outstanding actions for the team, becoming the only junior supporting fee earners shortly before a significant submission deadline — submission delivered on time
- Liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research and amended sections of the Claimant's memorial
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: prepared electronic bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and coordinated court materials and filings
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines, maintaining matter records in iManage
- Assisted with matter opening and closure, hearing arrangements, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes; prepared client notes

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from first client interview through to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies evidential issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains confidential case records to deadline
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; communicates complex rules clearly to vulnerable individuals
- Assesses eligibility for welfare benefits and housing support against statutory criteria; researches complex points and identifies evidential gaps

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline; translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and flagged provisions requiring legal input
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)**Technical skills:** iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems; document review**Case and evidence management:** Case-file organisation and maintenance; deadline tracking across concurrent matters; hearing bundle preparation; document scheduling; procedural histories